

EH&S Photo and Video Guidelines for Research Facilities

Filming and photography on campus by *non*-Stanford units require advance approval. For more information, see [Stanford’s photography and filming policies](#).

The Environmental Health & Safety Department (EH&S) created the following guidelines for Stanford units to safely conduct photo and video sessions in University locations with hazards while ensuring the images reflect health and safety requirements and best practices. Our intention is to provide guidelines that help creative teams and our research community stay safe while engaging in storytelling activities. **This visual guide is a resource for university communicators and their vendors to capture photography and video in a research facility and when selecting photos and videos for publication.** Requests for filming from third parties require advance review and approval to support perceptions of research integrity and to avoid commercial activities and perceptions of endorsement.

Who to contact with questions: If you have questions or need clarification regarding these guidelines around photography and video in a research environment:

- Amanda Litty** (alitty@stanford.edu), Marketing & Communications Lead, Environmental Health & Safety

Proper Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

Use this as a guide for determining if a researcher is wearing proper personal protective equipment (PPE) in a laboratory environment. **If the photography or video is intended for public viewing, please refrain from using the photography or video if a researcher is not wearing appropriate PPE.**

All PPE and safety requirements must be followed, even if a photo scenario is staged and props used or the researcher uses non-hazardous material (e.g., water). If you are unsure about the appropriate PPE for the area, please ask the researcher about which safety PPE is necessary under EH&S policy or contact Amanda Litty **directly**. EH&S is also available to review photography and video.

Do’s & Dont’s

Do’s

Wear a lab coat while in a lab space.
The lab coat should be buttoned and fit correctly.



Do wear hazard-specific protective eyewear when in a lab space and handling materials (glassware, specimens, lasers, robotics, etc.). Eyewear must be worn at **ALL TIMES** in a BSL-2 facility.

Protective eyewear is not required if only standing in a lab (non-BSL-2 or 3 spaces).

Wear long pants and closed-toed shoes.

Wear hazard appropriate gloves when handling glassware, specimens, or using machinery.



Keep long hair tied back.

Dont’s

Avoid wearing long hair down and long jewelry.

Don’t roll up lab coat sleeves, exposing skin on the arms. There should be no exposed skin between the end of the glove and the start of the lab coat sleeve.



Prescription eyeglasses are not a replacement for protective eyewear.

No exposed wrists



No exposed ankles, feet, and toes.

Laboratory Environment

Use this as a guide to determine if the lab environment is appropriate and camera-ready. If there is something in the photo or video inappropriate for a lab environment, clear the area if possible. If you are unable to, find a new location for the photoshoot or filming. **Do not publish photography or video that could give the impression of safety concerns to a public audience.**

Do’s & Dont’s

Do’s



- The lab bench and surrounding areas should be organized and tidy**, if visible in the photo. All chemical containers must be capped or lidded. Only materials that are in use are on the bench.



- Compressed air tanks should be properly secured to the wall or in a cage.**



- Any researchers who may be in the photo are wearing appropriate PPE.**

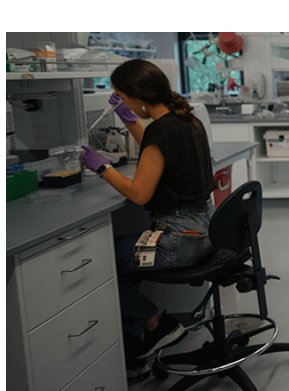
Dont’s



- No food or drink in the lab.**
- No visible clutter** (e.g. boxes, containers)
- No open chemical containers.**
- Do not obstruct emergency exits, pathways, or safety equipment** (safety shower, safety eyewash, fire extinguishers, etc.).



- Compressed air tanks cannot be free standing.**



- Researchers wearing incorrect PPE or no PPE at all should not be in the photo.**

Additional Guidance: Minors, Pets/Animals, and Other Items

Can minors be photographed or recorded in the lab?

No. Minors (anyone under 18) should not be present in the lab. The only exception is if they are participating in a university-sanctioned program (e.g., Summer Session). Photos with minors can be taken in office areas, hallways, lobbies, etc., but not in lab areas. **Parents or guardians must consent to the photo and/or video recording of a minor.** [Use this consent form](#) to obtain permission.

Are pets, house plants, or service animals allowed in the lab?

Pets and house plants should not appear in the lab environment. Service animals should wear appropriate PPE designed for animals. Questions or requests concerning service animals in the lab must go through the Office of Accessible Education **and** Environmental Health & Safety.

Can research animals be photographed or recorded?

NO photography or videography is allowed in any animal facility across campus without the prior approval of the Attending Veterinarian. Requests for approval can be submitted to Dr. Stephen Felt, Attending Veterinarian, at 650-723-5305 or felt@stanford.edu, and Dr. Monika Huss, monikag@stanford.edu.

Does the photographer need to wear PPE when in a lab?

Yes, photo and video crews should be prepared to comply with appropriate PPE requirements for the lab. Follow the PPE Do’s (stated above) or posted PPE guidance, if available. Crews may need to wear additional PPE depending on the hazard and what is established by the host (researcher, lab manager, etc). The host or Environmental Health & Safety can provide additional hazard specific guidance.